ERA 24

The War on Terror

2001 – 2011

9/11 · Afghanistan & Iraq · security vs. liberty

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the attacks of 9/11 reshape American foreign policy and civil liberties?

KEY TERMS

9/11 · the Bush Doctrine · the wars in Afghanistan & Iraq · the PATRIOT Act

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 9.5–9.6 · AMSCO Ch. 9.5–9.6

THE DAY EVERYTHING CHANGED

September 11, 2001

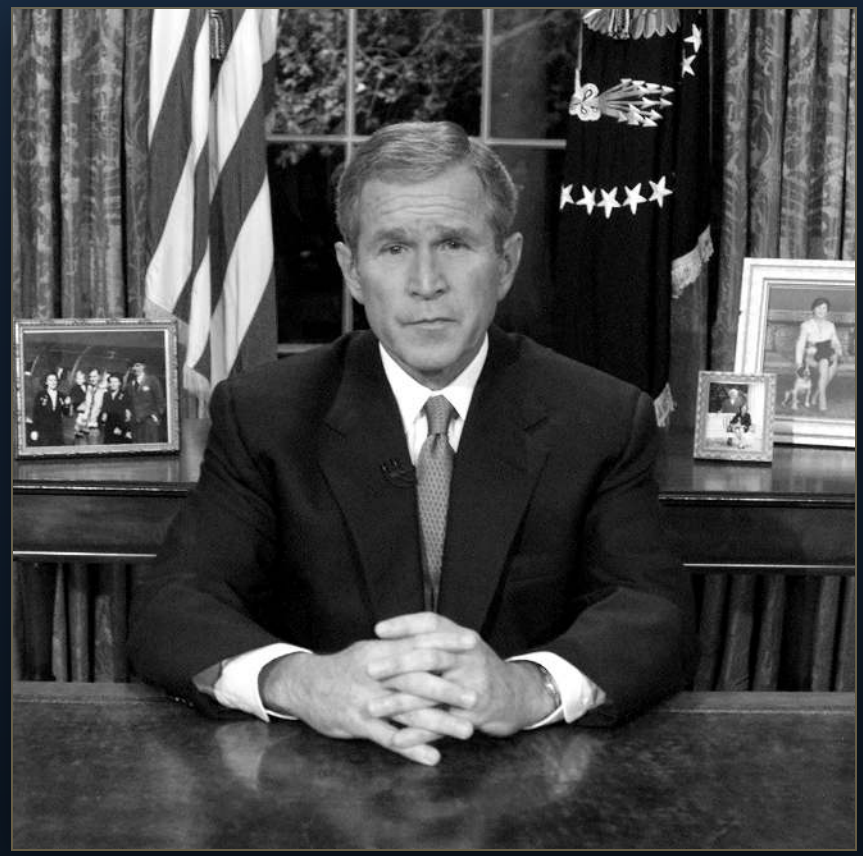
The 9/11 Attacks



- On **September 11, 2001**, **al-Qaeda** hijackers struck the World Trade Center and Pentagon.
- Nearly **3,000** people were killed in a single morning.
- **Osama bin Laden's** network had brought terror to American soil.

America Responds

- President **George W. Bush** declared a global '**War on Terror**.'
- The **Bush Doctrine** claimed the right to wage **preemptive war**.
- In 2001, the U.S. invaded **Afghanistan** to topple the **Taliban**.



Two Wars

I

Afghanistan

Toppled the **Taliban** that sheltered al-Qaeda—a war lasting 20 years.

II

Iraq

Invaded in 2003 over **weapons of mass destruction** that were never found.

III

A Long Occupation

Both wars became costly, drawn-out struggles with no clear victory.

Security vs. Liberty



- The **PATRIOT Act** expanded government surveillance powers.
- A new **Department of Homeland Security** coordinated the response.
- Detentions at **Guantanamo Bay** raised deep questions about **civil liberties**.

Remembering 9/11

- The attacks reshaped how Americans thought about security and the world.
- In 2011, U.S. forces finally killed **Osama bin Laden**.
- 9/11 left a lasting mark on American life and policy.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

The War on Terror

1. The **9/11 attacks** by **al-Qaeda** killed nearly 3,000 and launched a global **War on Terror**.
2. The **Bush Doctrine** led to long wars in **Afghanistan** and **Iraq**—the latter over WMD never found.
3. At home, the **PATRIOT Act** and **Guantanamo** forced a hard debate over **security and civil liberties**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The War on Terror

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how the **9/11 attacks** transformed U.S. foreign and domestic policy.

ARGUMENTATION

Did the **War on Terror** justify new limits on **civil liberties**? Make and defend a claim.

COMPARISON

Compare the wars in **Afghanistan** and **Iraq** in their justifications and outcomes.

Up next — **Lesson 57: Contemporary America** (the 21st century & its challenges)